

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

This month in ALT:

In Geek-key, we check out Iron-Man's arc reactors in detail. DGT Auto is all about the future of EVs in India. In DGT, check out some cool gadgets, stuff we've been messing around with, and what we've been watching.



Vodafone will soon let go of 3G network

Vodafone, which has approximately 18 million UK mobile users, will turn off the nearly two-decade-old network as demand declines, allowing it to focus on expanding its 4G and 5G networks with the freed up spectrum. The issue with Vodafone in the UK is that many of its users have chosen to stick with their 3G plan, as opposed to many other service-providers. <https://dgit.in/vodaauk>

WHAT'S NEW

Digital freedom on a continuous decline in Myanmar

After the execution of a coup last year, Myanmar Junta, the newly instated authorities, outlawed social media usage for citizens. The list of websites include Twitter, Instagram, and Facebook, which are Myanmar's primary internet gateways. Most people still used VPNs to get around the restrictions, but the government is cracking down on that too. Myanmar's military government is attempting to pass a new cybersecurity law that would punish anyone who used VPNs to access these restricted social media sites.

The proposed law would provide the regime



unrestricted access to user data, the ability to censor content it disapproves of, restrict internet

providers and intercept data, and the ability to arrest anyone who criticises the regime online as well as employees of non-compliant businesses. As it stands, the bill is on its way to be incorporated as law. This move is opposed by most citizens, IT firms and rights activists.

<https://dgit.in/cyblaw>

Google to block targeted ads for underage users

As the internet giant faces scrutiny over targeted advertisements being pushed via its platforms, Google will soon ban ad targeting based on the age, gender, or interests of persons under the age of 18. In 2022, Google plans to focus on enhancing protections for vulnerable groups and introducing innovative ways to give customers more control over their ad experiences, according to their statement.



With Privacy Sandbox, Google's Chrome browser is engineering a collaborative effort to make the web a private experience by itself, which aims to help reshape digital marketing in a way that respects your privacy standards. There are many instances

in the past where children were tricked into entering their parents' personal details to purchase an advertised product. Since targeted ads can also be socio-political in nature, they sometimes promote extreme perspectives to underage children which ends up influencing them in a wrong way. By blocking ads, Google claims to solve these main problems among many others. <https://dgit.in/targettedads>



Women-dominated STEM paths labelled 'Soft Sciences'

A study was conducted in which participants were instructed to read articles about women's representation in various STEM subjects and then categorise the topic as a 'soft' or 'hard' science. <https://dgit.in/softsci>



Bitcoin sees largest drop in 6 months

Bitcoin fell below \$33,000 recently, reaching its lowest level since July. It has subsequently rebounded beyond \$36,000, but it is still down about 50% from its highest point at nearly \$69,000 in November. <https://dgit.in/bitcoincrash>



Google Docs catches up with Microsoft Word

Google Docs users will now be able to add watermarks to their papers in the form of images and text. Additionally, if you upload a Word document with one, it will be retained, and if you export a file from Docs to a local format, it will be preserved as well. <https://dgit.in/wmdocs>